



ALPHA DATA

ALPHA DATA P.J.S.C

Higher Colleges of Technology

RFP Ref. NE-26-0129 — Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) — 3 Years

Governance, Audit, Legal & BCP

Full Compliance with SOW Sections 3.18 – 3.23

Portal Section 3 — Item 4 (Evaluation Criterion, Weight 10% — Full Compliance Band)

Technical Submission — September 2026

Commercial-in-Confidence

Alpha Data accepts and will operate the full governance, configuration-hygiene, compliance, business-continuity, audit and legal framework of Sections 3.18-3.23 — without deviation. This section summarises, clause family by clause family, exactly how each obligation is met.

1. Configuration Hygiene and Lifecycle Management (Section 3.18)

- Quarterly configuration audit across all policy rules, profiles, mappings, categories, integrations and certificate stores, with formal deliverables presented at each quarterly review.
- Unused-policy identification: all rules unmatched for 90 days flagged with disable/archive/delete recommendations.
- Orphaned-object clean-up each quarter with a written removal summary: unreferenced groups, unused IP objects, expired certificates, stale DNS entries, disabled integrations, decommissioned accounts.
- Approved, version-controlled configuration baseline ("gold standard") signed off by HCT at deployment end and after each major change; automated drift detection alerting both parties; unauthorised drift remediated within 4 hours.
- Automated daily configuration backups, 365-day retention, demonstrated restore to any prior state within 2 hours for P1 incidents.
- Immutable change-audit logging: requestor, approver, timestamp, description and before/after diff for every change, available to HCT for audit.

2. Compliance and Regulatory Requirements (Section 3.19)

- UAE national compliance: UAE Information Assurance (IA) Regulation (TDRA), NESA framework alignment, Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021 (Personal Data Protection) including processing, transfer, data-subject rights and breach notification, and applicable UAE Cybersecurity Council directives.
- International standards: platform and operations supporting HCT's compliance with NIST CSF 2.0, NIST SP 800-171, ISO/IEC 27001:2022, PCI-DSS v4.0 (where applicable), FERPA and CIS Controls v8.
- HCT Information Security Requirements Baseline (Section 3.19.4 / 5.x checklist): the complete Information Security Requirements Checklist is answered item-by-item (Yes/No/N/A with evidence) in the attached checklist response covering governance, risk, access control, data protection, network, SSDLC, endpoint, cryptography, incident response, BCM, physical, supply chain, vulnerability management, logging, change management, legal, database security and personnel security.
- Data residency: HCT data stored and processed only in regions approved by HCT in writing; no HCT data used for AI training, analytics or advertising; return-and-verified-deletion within 30 days at termination.

3. Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery (Section 3.20)

- Documented, annually tested BCP/DRP specific to the SASE platform and HCT services, provided prior to contract signing and updated annually, with test results shared (scenarios include PoP loss, cloud-partner outage, cyber incident and personnel unavailability).

- Minimum two geographically separated UAE/GCC PoPs, each independently capable of 100% of HCT traffic; automatic failover within 60 seconds with no session loss; failover tested quarterly with results to HCT.
- PoP degradation/failover notification to HCT within 30 minutes and full incident report within 24 hours.
- (Optional ZTNA) Connector/gateway failover Primary→DR within 60 seconds, demonstrated during PoC; documented fallback procedure for extended broker unavailability (>1 hour).
- Force majeure handling per SOW, including the 30-day termination right for prolonged events.

4. Governance Framework (Section 3.21)

Level	Frequency	Alpha Data Participants	Scope
Operational Review	Monthly	Operations Lead, Technical Lead	Tickets, SLA performance, incidents, config changes, upcoming maintenance
Service Management Review	Quarterly	Account Manager, Operations Lead, Technical Director	SLA trends, capacity planning, config audit, risk register, roadmap, scorecard
Strategic Steering Committee	Bi-annual	Country Manager / Regional Director, Account Director, Technical Director	Contract performance, strategy, roadmap, escalations, benchmarking, annual business review

- Vendor performance scorecard maintained above 85% with the full Section 3.21.1 KPI set (MTTD <5 min, detection >99%, FP <0.1%, change success >99%, drift <2/quarter, DEM >85, 100% on-time reporting and training).
- Dispute resolution per the 3.21.2 escalation ladder: operational (5 days) → senior management (10 days) → executive, before any formal proceedings.
- Quarterly risk register review and update as part of governance (3.13.8).

5. Audit and Assurance (Section 3.22)

- HCT right to audit accepted in full: routine annual audits on 30 days' notice with full cooperation (documentation, personnel, facilities, platform data); immediate audits on 48 hours' notice following incidents or material SLA breaches.
- Audit remediation SLAs accepted: Critical 15 business days, High 30, Medium 60, with remediation plan within 10 business days of findings.
- Independent third-party penetration testing (CREST-accredited or equivalent) of in-scope components annually and after significant changes, with reports and remediation plans shared per 3.22.5.
- Real-time SIEM forwarding (syslog CEF/LEEF) operating independently of online retention; 12-month log retention with configurable extension; portal search optimisation transparently documented in the compliance matrix (3.22.3.5) with full-term retention met via forwarding and archival.
- Cryptographically hashed configuration audit baseline at deployment end; unauthorised deviation treated as P2 security incident.
- Annual joint tabletop exercises with HCT covering exfiltration, platform-bypass and APT scenarios.

6. Legal Protections and Contract Governance (Section 3.23)

Obligation	Alpha Data Position
Transition assistance (3.23.5) and termination rights (3.23.3), incl. termination for convenience on 90 days' notice and for cause (chronic SLA failure, certification loss, breach)	Accepted in full
Intellectual property (3.23.2): all custom policies, configurations, automations, scripts, documentation and reports created for HCT are HCT's sole property; perpetual licence to embedded vendor IP; all HCT data (logs, metadata, analytics) remains HCT property	Accepted in full
Quarterly data escrow (3.23.6): complete configuration and policy export in vendor-neutral JSON/XML — policies, mappings, app definitions, integrations, URL customisations, certificate inventory (excl. private keys), platform parameters	Accepted; automated quarterly export delivered to HCT
Cyber insurance cooperation (3.23.7): full cooperation with HCT's insurer including documentation, evidence, timelines and personnel access	Accepted in full
Governing law and jurisdiction (3.23.8): UAE law; exclusive jurisdiction of Abu Dhabi courts, subject to the 3.21.2 dispute ladder	Accepted in full
Vendor lock-in mitigation (3.16.7, referenced): open standards (SAML/OIDC, SCIM, CEF/LEEF, STIX/TAXII, syslog RFC 5424, RADIUS/CoA, REST/OpenAPI, IPsec); proprietary elements disclosed and documented with migration guidance; cleanly uninstallable agent	Accepted in full
Indemnification for third-party IP infringement (SOW 1.8)	Accepted in full

Attachments: Completed HCT Information Security Requirements Checklist; Alpha Data BCP/DRP summary and ISO 22301:2019 certificate; platform ISO 27001 / SOC 2 Type II / CSA STAR attestations (under NDA); sample quarterly configuration review deliverable set.